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JEANNE BROWN

Department of Linguistics, McGill University
1085 Ave Dr Penfield #104, Montreal, QC, H3A 1A7
jeanne.brown@mail.mcgill.ca; jeanne-brown.github.io

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D) in Linguistics, McGill University Sep 2022–Aug 2027 (expected)

From discourse to data: Empirical approaches to studying sociophonetic variation within the Canadian landscape – Co-supervised by Prof. Morgan Sonderegger & Prof. Meghan Clayards

Master of Arts in Linguistics, University of Ottawa Sep 2019–Aug 2020

An acoustic study of voicing and register in Northern Raglai – Supervised by Prof. Marc Brunelle

Joint Honours Bachelor of Arts in Psychology & Linguistics, University of Ottawa Sep 2015–Apr 2019

Additional training

Student, LSA Summer Institute, University of Oregon Jul 2025–Aug 2025

PUBLICATIONS

Brown, J., & Clayards, M. (2026). Disentangling acoustic and social biases in creaky voice perception: The effects of f0 and face gender on creakiness ratings. *Laboratory Phonology, 17*(1), 1–46. https://doi.org/10.16995/labphon.24285

Brown, J., & Sonderegger, M. (2025). A sociophonetic study of creaky voice across language, gender and age in Canadian English-French bilinguals. *Journal of Phonetics, 112*, 101431. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.wocn.2025.101431

Brunelle, M., Brown, J. & Hà, P. T. T. (2022). Northern Raglai voicing and its relation to Southern Raglai register: evidence for early stages of registrogenesis. *Phonetica*, *79*(2), 151–188. https://doi.org/10.1515/phon-2022-2019

Brown, J. & Sonderegger, M. (in press). Une étude sociophonétique de la voix craquée en français laurentien. *Les voies du français,* Presses de l'Université Laval, 1–31. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/c6au5_v1

Brown, J. & Sonderegger, M. (under review). A causal mediation analysis of creaky voice acoustics: Evidence for f0 as a mediator of gender effects, 1–30. https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.7333498

CONFERENCES

Invited talks

Brown, J. (2026, May 14). *Rethinking "young women's creak": Piecing together production, perception, and social evidence* [Invited talk]. The 190th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America, Philadelphia, USA.

Presentations & proceedings

Brown, J. (2026, October 24). *Perceptual accessibility of the Ontario-Quebec French dialect boundary* [Poster]. New Ways of Analyzing Variation 54, Montreal, Canada.

Brown, J. (2026, June 28). *Modelling the acoustic structure of creaky voice: Mediation and factor analysis* [Poster]. The 20th Conference on Laboratory Phonology, Montreal, Canada.

Brown, J., & Clayards, M. (2025, December 4). *Creaky voice perception modulated by f0 and gender cues* [Poster]. The 6th Joint Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America & the Acoustical Society of Japan, Honolulu, USA.

Brown, J. (2025, June 3). *Acoustic correlates in the production of creaky voice: Mediation by f0* [Talk]. 72nd Annual Canadian Linguistics Association Conference, Montreal, Canada.

Brown, J. (2025, April 5). *Gender and age effects of creaky voice acoustics: Mediation by f0* [Talk]. Montreal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics Workshop (MOTh 2025), Toronto, Canada.

Brown, J. & Sonderegger, M. (2024, June 28). *Creaky voice variation across language and gender in Canadian English-French bilingual speech* [Poster]. The 19th Conference on Laboratory Phonology, Seoul, South Korea.

Brown, J. & Sonderegger, M. (2024, June 10). *Une étude sociophonétique de la voix craquée en français laurentien* [Talk]. 9e colloque Les français d'ici 2024, Shippagan, Canada.

Brown, J. & Sonderegger, M. (2024, May 14). *Creaky voice across language, gender and age: A study of Canadian English-French bilingual speech* [Poster]. The 186th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America & Acoustics Week in Canada, Ottawa, Canada.

Brown, J. & Sonderegger, M. (2024, April 19). *Creaky voice in Canadian English-French bilinguals: An acoustic study across language, gender and age* [Poster]. Montreal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics Workshop (MOTh 2024), Montreal, Canada.

Brown, J. (2023, October 14). *A sociophonetic study of creaky voice in Canadian English and French* [Poster]. New Ways of Analyzing Variation 51, Queens, USA.

Brown, J. (2023). Creaky voice in Canadian English: An acoustics-focused method [Proceedings paper]. *Canadian Acoustics, 51*(3), 198–199. https://jcaa.caa-aca.ca/index.php/jcaa/article/view/4091

Brunelle, M., & Brown, J. (2021, July 5). *Voicing and register in Raglai dialects: The underpinnings of transphonologization* [Invited talk]. ICU Linguistics Colloquium: Spring 2021, Mitaka, Japan. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gALXs6vVw2Q

Tạ, T., Brunelle, M., & Brown, J. (2020, December 20). *Onset voicing and register in Northern Raglai, Chrau and Arem* [Talk]. The Fourth International Conference on the Linguistics of Vietnam, Hanoi, Vietnam. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_55RoMo6U8I

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

Co-supervisor, Department of Linguistics, McGill University

Joint Honours Undergraduate Thesis – with Prof. Meghan Clayards — Sep 2026–Apr 2027

Gender presentation and the perception of non-binary voices

Course planning; weekly supervisory meetings; training in sociolinguistic fieldwork (data collection), perception experiment design, acoustic analysis, statistical analysis; grading and provision of feedback.

Undergraduate RA work (2 students) – with Prof. Morgan Sonderegger & Prof. Meghan Clayards — May 2026–Aug 2026

Training in data collection and corpus processing; weekly lab meetings.

Course Lecturer, Department of Linguistics, McGill University (part-time contract, paid)

Sociolinguistics 1 (*LING320*; ~80 students) — Jan 2027–Apr 2027

Introduction to Speech Science (*LING210*; 84 students) — Sep 2025–Dec 2025

Bi-weekly 1.5-hour lectures; course planning; grading and provision of feedback; consultations (office hours, email); regular meetings with TA.

Guest Lecturer, Department of Linguistics, McGill University

Introduction to Speech Science (*LING210,* Prof. Meghan Clayards, Dr. Andrei Munteanu, Kuilin Li) — Sep 2024, May 2025, May 2026

Lecture on voice quality and sociophonetics.

Teaching Assistant, Department of Linguistics, McGill University (part-time contract, paid)

Phonetics 3 (*LING330*), Dr. Andrei Munteanu — Jan 2025–Apr 2025

Introduction to Speech Science (*LING210*), Prof. Meghan Clayards — Sep 2024–Dec 2024

Language Acquisition I (*LING355*), Prof. Heather Goad — Jan 2024–Apr 2024

Introduction to Linguistics (*LING201*), Dr. Andrei Munteanu — Sep 2023–Dec 2023

Teaching Assistant, Department of Linguistics, University of Ottawa (part-time contract, paid)

Acoustique de la parole (*LIN4726*), Prof. Marc Brunelle — Sep 2019–Dec 2019

Introduction à la phonologie (*LIN2720*), Prof. Marc Brunelle — Jan 2020–Apr 2020

Théorie syntaxique (*LIN3710*), Dr. Myriam Dali — Sep 2019–Dec 2019

Teaching lab/discussion sessions; grading and provision of feedback; consultations (office hours, email); regular meetings with instructors.

WORK EXPERIENCE

20th Conference on Laboratory Phonology (LabPhon 20) Co-organizer — May 2025–Jun 2026
(part-time contract, paid / part-time volunteer)
Chairs: Morgan Sonderegger, Meghan Clayards, Suzy Ahn, Beth MacLeod

Volunteer leadership and coordination (~30-person team); communications and conference logistics (venue, catering, accommodations, furniture rental, attendee information materials); budget-planning/tracking; event planning (welcome reception, conference dinner, student social); on-site execution.

Research Coordinator, Prof. Patricia Cleave, School of Communication Sciences and Disorders, Dalhousie University (part-time contract, paid) — Apr 2021–Apr 2023

The Discourse Skills of Monolingual and Bilingual School-Aged Children

Transcription team leadership, audio transcription and revision of transcripts (French); online promotion of the research study and participant recruitment; remote testing sessions with children aged 7–12 years; communications with parents and collection of questionnaire data; maintenance of data files, participant records, and transcripts; scoring of expository speech data (in English and French).

Freelance Transcriber, Prof. Wendy Bokhorst-Heng & Prof. Kelle Marshall, School of Education, Crandall University (part-time contract, paid) — Oct 2021–Apr 2022

Audio transcription (French) of the *French Language and Intercultural Competencies (ED4163)* course.

Research Assistant, Prof. Stephen Levey, Department of Linguistics, University of Ottawa (part-time contract, paid) — Feb 2019–Dec 2021

Learning to Sound Like a Native Speaker: The acquisition of sociolinguistic competence in English by Canadian Francophones

Data extraction and analysis, coding of linguistic variables; conduction of sociolinguistic interviews (in French and English, using ZoomH4N recorders); audio transcription (French).

Research Assistant, Prof. Marc Brunelle, Sound Patterns Laboratory, Department of Linguistics, University of Ottawa (part-time contract, paid/part-time volunteer) — Jan 2019–Jul 2021

Voicing and its transphonologization: The initiation and actuation of a sound change in Southeast Asia

Data analysis & visualization, statistical analysis; annotation of speech recordings (audio, EGG, waveforms, spectrograms).

Linguistic Consultant (part-time contract, paid)

Productive Playhouse Inc. — Oct 2021–Nov 2021

Phonemic transcription, homograph mapping (European French to Canadian French) for text-to-speech programs.

Pole to Win (now, *Side*) Oct 2020–Mar 2021

Phonemic transcription, proofreading, audio recording quality checks for text-to-speech synthesis.

Linguistics Tutor (part-time private practice, paid) Oct 2019–Apr 2021

Consultation for undergraduate phonology, morphology, semantics, psycholinguistics, second language acquisition

FUNDING & AWARDS

Doctoral Research Scholarship [373124] – Fonds de recherche du Québec, Société et Culture ($58,334CAD) May 2025–Aug 2027

Graduate Student Travel Award – Centre for Research on Brain, Language and Music ($350CAD, each) Sep 2023, Sep 2025

McCall MacBain Fellowship in Arts – Faculty of Arts, McGill University ($11,000CAD) Sep 2024–Aug 2025

General Institute Fellowship – Linguistics Society of America ($2,500USD) Jul 2025–Aug 2025

Graduate Mobility Award – Government of Québec/McGill University ($1,573CAD) Jul 2025–Aug 2025

***Summa cum laude* Distinction** – University of Ottawa Apr 2019

Edward Sapir Scholarship in Linguistics – Department of Linguistics, University of Ottawa ($1,000CAD) Jan 2018

KNOWLEDGE MOBILIZATION

Press conference (presentation, Q&A)

190th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America, Philadelphia, USA 12 May 2026

"Rethinking "young women's creak": Piecing together production, perception, and social evidence"

Press release

190th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America, Philadelphia, USA 14 May 2026

"Challenging biases about vocal fry"

Interview

CBC Radio, *As It Happens* 14 May 2026

Interviewed by Leslie Amminson (not ultimately aired)

New Scientist: "Vocal fry is more common in men, actually, find scientists" 14 May 2026

Interviewed by Karmela Padavic-Callaghan

Media coverage

Ars Technica: "Men use "vocal fry" more than women, counter to stereotype" 14 May 2026

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Member, Committee on Linguistic Institutes and Fellowships, Linguistic Society of America Jan 2027–

Evaluation of applications for Linguistic Institute financial support and preparing rank-ordered lists of fellowship applicants.

Peer Reviewer

Journal of the International Phonetic Association 2025

Speech Communication 2026

McLing Student Editor, Department of Linguistics, McGill University Aug 2025–Aug 2026

Collecting and publishing departmental news via blog posts.

President Sep 2024–Sep 2025

Post-Graduate Student Society (PGSS) Councillor Jan 2025–Sep 2025

Vice President of Internal Affairs Sep 2023–Sep 2024

GLAM (Graduate Linguistics Association of McGill), McGill University

Supervision of all GLAM activities; organization of Open House (2024 & 2025); GLAM representative and voting member at monthly PGSS meetings; event planning (student/department socials).

P* Reading Group Organizer, Department of Linguistics, McGill University Sep 2023–Apr 2025

Schedule planning; technical set-up (hybrid format).

Montreal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics Workshop (MOT^{h}) Organizing Committee

Department of Linguistics, McGill University Apr 2024

Department of Linguistics, University of Ottawa (cancelled due to COVID-19) Mar 2020

Schedule planning; budgeting; abstract review; event planning (dinner); drafting/translating online content.

Committee of Graduate Studies MA Student Representative Sep 2019–Aug 2020

Social Committee Member Sep 2019–Aug 2020

ADLINGA (Association des diplômés en linguistique/Linguistics Graduate Association), University of Ottawa

Graduate student advocacy; event planning & budgeting (thesis defense receptions, student socials).

SKILLS

Languages	Native proficiency in (Canadian) English & French
Programming & statistics	R (proficient; *lme4, brms, ggplot2, tidyverse*), Python (basic), SPSS (basic), GitHub (basic), High-Performance Computing clusters (intermed.)
Speech analysis	Praat/Praat scripting, Audacity, speaker diarization (*pyannote*), automatic transcription (*Whisper*), forced alignment (*MFA*)
Experiment design	Gorilla Experiment Builder, Prolific
Open Science	Open data and materials (*OSF*)

REFERENCES

Available upon request.